

Stop Telling Me to Travel like a Local, Okay?

Mari Uyehara

1 [1] In all my years of travel, from twisting off bits of pastry in gold-tinged Vienna coffee houses to stumbling around the jungle-wrapped temple ruins in Cambodia, I have relied on the condensed wisdom of those who knew those places well to find my way through abbreviated stays. 定语从句

[2] I plan my trips like a cultural interloper, making sure to hit the “only-here” greatest hits like the tourist that I very much am. 定语从句

[3] This is not the going wisdom these days.

条件状语从句

2 [4] If you have researched a trip in, say, the past five to ten years or so, you may have noticed a recurring and aggressive directive: TRAVEL LIKE A LOCAL!

[5] You’ve probably also seen the entreaty, the shaming: How to Not Look like a Tourist; How to Not Act like a Tourist; How to Not Be a Tourist.

3 [6] On the surface, the promise is an attractive one: You’re getting the inside scoop for the best places to eat and shop with none of the tourist traps.

[7] You know only the spots that those truly in the know can find. 定语从句

[8] But it’s all a complete farce.

[9] At best, “Travel like a Local” is a silly paradoxical myth; at worst, it’s terrible vacation advice.

4 [10] For one thing, locals aren’t traveling.

[11] They are working.

[12] Or folding laundry or cleaning their bathrooms or packing lunches or any of the eight zillion other inane chores that somehow take up every minute of your free time when you are NOT on vacation. 定语从句

时间状语从句

They are

[13] Locals **are not spending** leisurely days **strolling on** **stunning** promenades or gawking at the **crank-your-neck-tall** Art Deco buildings or sparkly **turquoise** waters lapping on fine white-sand beaches.

[14] They **are making** to-do lists in their heads on **cramped** morning commutes or **scurrying** between the grocery store, the dry cleaner, and the pharmacy, trying to complete enough tasks before falling into bed.

[15] The whole point of travel **is** to get away from the **humdrum** of everyday life.

[16] It **is** to very much not be a local.

5 [17] **Put** it this way: You simply **cannot travel** like a local.

[18] It **is** a **contradiction** in terms.

[19] Staying at a neighborhood Airbnb in Mexico City's Roma **doesn't make** you a **Chilango**.

[20] Parisians **don't nibble** on buttery pastries every day for breakfast while **overlooking** the Seine.

[21] And rarely **do** New Yorkers **tuck** into a three-hour tasting menu on a Tuesday night.

[22] And locals certainly **don't eat** 17 meals in a week at some of the best—and, at times, most expensive—restaurants in town.

[23] (Perhaps they **are saving up** to do so when they **go on** their own non-local **sojourn**.)

时间状语从句

6 [24] Locals **pick up** takeout and **watch** a junky TV drama in their pajamas.

[25] They **re not going** to three museums and a boat tour before **draining** their bank account on regional textiles, which as a non-local you **should** definitely **not miss**!

定语从句

[26] Neither **do** locals **wander** around a city with fresh eyes until their feet **are** sore.

时间状语从句

[27] These **are** the unique pleasures of being a tourist.

7 [28] Getting the most out of your visit to a place **requires** acknowledging both ignorance and vulnerability and that you **don't know** much and **need** some help. 宾语从句

[29] There **s** nothing wrong with that: Remedial cultural lessons **are** both fun and necessary. 宾语从句

[30] I **love** taking cooking classes, typically **chock-full** of naive tourists in dorky aprons, and market tours in different cities.

[31] Sure, I **can** and **have visited** markets without guides and **enjoyed** it, but having an actual expert to explain ingredients and practices I **couldn't** **intuit** on my own **makes** the experience all the richer. (have) 定语从句 (that)

8 [32] More than that, being that vulnerable, ignorant non-local sometimes **gets** you special treatment.

[33] Some of my best travel experiences **arose from** a very un-local ineptitude and the kindness and **hospitality** shown by actual locals.

[34] In a small village in northern Thailand, a woman once **closed down** her coffee shop, despite my **pleas** not to, to drive me on her motorbike to a rice noodle factory when I merely **asked** her for directions. 时间状语从句

[35] In Kyoto, **when** I **asked about** ceramic stores at a small coffee shop—because as a dumb tourist I **did not know** where they **were**—I **got** an invite into a couple's home to learn **kintsugi**, the Japanese art of repairing broken pottery with gold or silver. 时间状语从句 原因状语从句 宾语从句

[36] I **'ve been whisked** from an artisan bread bakery to a **macaroon** shop in Paris by friends with cheery **gusto**.

[37] Hospitality to visitors **is** a gift; **embrace** it with gratitude, not shame. 宾语从句

9 [38] The bid to “Travel like a Local”—with suggestions to buy the **de rigueur anorak** in Copenhagen and study maps on your phone lest you **stick out** as a foreigner—all **seems** a little middle-schoolish. 原因状语从句

[39] At the stage in life when you can book your own trip abroad, you're old enough to not worry about fitting in.

[40] (This is, of course, distinct from respecting local customs on religious and cultural dress.)

[41] One of the delicious freedoms in traveling is that no one knows you, that there is a very low likelihood that your ex-boyfriend will happen upon you covered in dust and sweat after a half day of hiking around temple ruins.

[42] You can wear a fanny pack or shoes that you don't mind muddying up.

[43] You can ask a stranger for directions.

10 [44] Now that I think about it, acting like a tourist in your hometown—which, yes, I admit is also a contradiction in terms—seems like a better way to approach your everyday life too.

[45] Taking a bus tour through town will give you a completely different perspective.

[46] Actually visiting a museum—instead of meaning to—is way more fulfilling than sitting on your couch cruising Twitter and Instagram.

[47] I've never been to the Statue of Liberty in New York or the Emily Dickinson house in my home state of Massachusetts.

[48] It's been years since I've visited the Cloisters in Upper Manhattan and many months since I've hiked through the Mt. Holyoke range 15 minutes from the house where I grew up.

[49] That urgent tourist energy to see and do all sorts of things is far superior to the apathy of knowing something will always be there. (that)

[50] Maybe it's best not just to travel like a tourist, but to live like one too.

Two Ways of Seeing a River

Mark Twain

1[1] The face of the water, in time, became a wonderful book—a book that was a dead language to the uneducated passenger, but which told its mind to me without reserve, delivering its most cherished secrets as clearly as if it uttered them with a voice.

[2] And it was not a book to be read once and thrown aside, for it had a new story to tell every day.

[3] Throughout the long twelve hundred miles there was never a page that was void of interest, never one that you could leave unread without loss, never one that you would want to skip, thinking you could find higher enjoyment in some other thing.

[4] There never was so wonderful a book written by man; never one whose interest was so absorbing, so unflagging, so sparkingly renewed with every re-perusal.

[5] The passenger who could not read it was charmed with a peculiar sort of faint dimple on its surface (on the rare occasions when he did not overlook it altogether); but to the pilot that was an italicized passage; indeed, it was more than that, it was a legend of the largest capitals, with a string of shouting exclamation points at the end of it; for it meant that a wreck or a rock was buried there that could tear the life out of the strongest vessel that ever floated.

[6] It is the faintest and simplest expression the water ever makes, and the most hideous to a pilot's eye.

[7] In truth, the passenger who could not read this book saw nothing but all manner of pretty pictures in it, painted by the sun and shaded by the clouds, whereas to the trained eye these were not pictures at all, but the grimmest and most dead-earnest of reading matter.

2[8] Now when I had mastered the language of this water and had come to know every trifling feature that bordered the great river as familiarly as I knew the letters of the alphabet, I had made a valuable acquisition.

[9] But I had lost something, too.

[10] I had lost something which could never be restored to me while I lived.

[11] All the grace, the beauty, the poetry had gone out of the majestic river!

[12] I still keep in mind a certain wonderful sunset which I witnessed when steamboating was new to me.

[13] A broad expanse of the river was turned to blood; in the middle distance the red hue brightened into gold, through which a solitary log came floating, black and conspicuous; in one place a long, slanting mark lay sparkling upon the water; in another the surface was broken by boiling, tumbling rings, that were as many-tinted as an opal; where the ruddy flush was faintest, was a smooth spot that was covered with graceful circles and radiating lines, ever so delicately traced; the shore on our left was densely wooded, and the somber shadow that fell from this forest was broken in one place by a long, ruffled trail that shone like silver; and high above the forest wall a clean-stemmed dead tree waved a single leafy bough that glowed like a flame in the unobstructed splendor that was flowing from the sun.

[14] There were graceful curves, reflected images, woody heights, soft distances; and over the whole scene, far and near, the dissolving lights drifted steadily, enriching it, every passing moment, with new marvels of coloring.

3[15] I stood like one bewitched.

[16] I drank it in, in a speechless rapture.

[17] The world was new to me, and I had never seen anything like this at home.

[18] But as I have said, a day came when I began to cease from noting the glories and the charms which the moon and the sun and the twilight wrought upon the river's face; another day came when I ceased altogether to note them.

[19] Then, if that sunset scene had been repeated, I should have looked upon it without rapture, and should have commented upon it, inwardly, after this fashion: This sun means that we are going to have wind tomorrow; that floating log means that the river is rising, small thanks to it; that slanting mark on the water refers to a bluff reef which is going to kill somebody's steamboat one of these nights, if it keeps on stretching out like that; those tumbling "boils" show a dissolving bar and a changing channel there; the lines and circles in the slick water over yonder are a warning that that troublesome place is shoaling up dangerously; that silver streak in the shadow of the forest is the "break" from a new snag, and he has located himself in the very best place he could have found to fish for steamboats; that tall dead tree, with a single living branch, is not going to last long, and then how is a body ever going to get through this blind place at night without the friendly old landmark.

4[20] No, the romance and the beauty were all gone from the river.

[21] All the value any feature of it had for me now was the amount of usefulness it could furnish toward compassing the safe piloting of a steamboat.

[22] Since those days, I have pitied doctors from my heart.

[23] What does the lovely flush in a beauty's cheek mean to a doctor but a "break" that ripples above some deadly disease

[24] Are not all her visible charms sown thick with what are to him the signs and symbols of hidden decay?

[25] Does he ever see her beauty at all, or doesn't he simply view her professionally, and comment upon her unwholesome condition all to himself?

[26] And doesn't he sometimes wonder whether he has gained most or lost most by learning his trade?